Social Media Marketing

Social Media Branding

Summary Notes

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Lesson objectives

- Define a brand
- Elements of brand development
- Importance of brand consistency
- Common branding issues
- Effective brand identity

Fun Fact

DID YOU KNOW: It takes five to seven impressions for people to remember a brand.

What is a brand?

A brand can be defined as a concept for a company, product or service that is publicly distinguished from other products, services and concepts.

Before starting brand development ensure that you;

- Conduct research
- Consider who your buyer persona is
- Investigate what your competitors are doing
- Assess your existing brand

Elements of social media branding

Logo

Your logo should be clear, identifiable and memorable. It should be easily recognised across multiple platforms and devices. If you have a symbol version of your logo it is always best to use on social media as the space is limited. Include your logo in your videos.

When developing or assessing your logo, ask yourself;

- Does it effectively communicate what your brand is about?
- Are you able to adapt it for multiple purposes?
- Is it memorable and impactful?
- Is it relevant to your products, services or industry?

Colour

We associate various emotions with colour, so the colours that you use for your brand will have subconscious associations.
Blue: integrity, trust, tranquility, loyalty, intelligence
Green: money, growth, freshness, environmental-friendliness
Yellow: happiness, originality, energy
Purple: royalty, spirituality, luxury
Pink: femininity, compassion, playfulness
Red: power, strength, passion
Orange: courage, originality, success
White: cleanliness, purity, freshness
Black: elegance, drama, strength

When developing or assessing your brand, consider the following;

- What emotions are your brand colours associated with?
- Do those emotions align with your brand and industry?
- Do you colours complement each other?
- Do you stand out against your competitors?

Typography

Like colours, the type of font that you use also has emotional associations.
● **Serif Fonts, including Times New Roman, Georgia, and Garamond:** Authoritative,

Traditional, Respectable
● **Sans Serif Fonts, including Helvetica, Arial, and Verdana:** Modern, Clean, Stable
● **Slab Serif Fonts, including Rockwell, Courier, and Museo:** Bold, Strong, Modern
● **Script Fonts, including Lobster, Lucida, and Brush Script:** Elegant, Friendly,

Creative
● **Modern Fonts, including Politica, Eurostyle, and Matchbook:** Fashionable, Stylish,

Exclusive

When developing or assessing your brand, consider;

- What emotional associations are linked to the fonts that you are using?
- Does this accurately reflect your brand and industry?
- Do these fonts appeal to your target audience?
- Do your primary and secondary fonts complement each other?

Visuals

There is a lot to consider when it comes to visuals from the photographs you use to any iconography, interactive elements, style of your videos, how you visualise data not only on your social media platforms but on your website, within email communications that you send out and even your more traditional forms of marketing.

When developing or assessing your visuals, ask yourself;

- If your visuals match your brand and industry?
- Do your visuals tell a story?
- Are your images consistent, eye-catching and impactful?
- Are they simplistic enough to be easily recognised on multiple devices?

Brand voice

When looking at your brand voice - imagine that your brand is a character or has a persona, what tone would they take when conversing, what language do they use when speaking and what is the purpose for them saying what they are saying.

When developing or assessing your brand, look at;

- What kind of character attributes your brand has: is it friendly, warm, authoritative, professional?
- What is the underlying vibe that emanates from your brand's communications: is it personal, honest, clinical, humble?
- What kind of language do you use in your communication: is it fun, savvy, serious, packed with jargon?
- What is the purpose behind your communication on social media: is it to educate, entertain, inspire, promote?

Why is branding so important in social media?

Easily recognisable online

We know that it takes five to seven interactions with a brand before people remember it - if they are seeing your brand on different social media channels but don't link it with your brand then
how do you expect them to remember you?

Creates trust

A consistent presence makes your brand look professional and therefore creates trust between online users and your brand followed by a good product and excellent customer service.

Drives brand loyalty

Why do we become loyal to certain brands? They probably have a proven product that works but even more than that - because we can relate to that brand. Something in that brand rings true in ourselves.

Entices new customers

If we have a solid brand that users or consumers can rely upon to be informed, be entertained, be inspired then it is much easier to attract new potential customers and increase our online presence through organic word of mouth. People trust people they know!

SEO benefits

A consistent presence also has a whole lot of search engine optimisation benefits as we use consistent keywords the search will start to identify our online brand presence with those specific keywords.

When you have a consistent brand presence online, your customer journey starts to look like this:

Common branding challenges

Making an impact
There is a lot of noise online, a lot to see, a lot to do and a lot to get distracted by. Brands often battle to make an impact with their online content.

Being original
Coming up with concepts that no one else in your industry is using can be difficult and very time-consuming!

Engaging prospects
Particularly if you are a team of 1, it can be difficult to maintain engagement on different platforms.

Growing reach and shares
When you first implement a strategy there will automatically be an increase in your reach and shares, however, this eventually plateaus. Continuously growing your reach and shares requires all of the above - impactful content that is original and that engages your prospects.

Impact on mobile
With a mobile first online world - ensuring that your content makes an impact within the length of a scroll on mobile is extremely important.

What makes effective branding?

Distinct
Your brand sets you apart from your competitors.

Memorable
Your brand makes a visual impact.

Scalable and flexible
It is able to grow and evolve.

Cohesive
The various elements of the brand should complement each other.

Easy to apply
Should be clear and intuitive for both designers and consumers.